

For over 50 years of academic programs in all classes of society – particularly in Hong Kong and Singapore, among others – medicine, engineering and professional disciplines like law and business have been the most attractive programs for parents to encourage their children to enrol in. However, while all of these programs have their merits and benefits, it is my faithful reminder that without the study of human interaction, behaviour and communications, the students would find themselves irrelevant in a fast-changing world and would be restricted in enabling their professional effectiveness in a given situation. It is clearly evidenced when new graduates are undergoing job interviews; many are unable to piece together a complete and comprehensible sentence. In fact, a considerable number of graduates utterly lack social skills and even a basic understanding of human behaviour. The evident uneasiness in interviews and group settings of even those armed with five years of work experience is even more troubling in management education.

What are the caveats to further management education?

Hypercompetitive competition and economic turbulence never before seen at this rate have caused all of us to be focused around growth and change in the midst of increasing shrinking profitability. In this era of rapid innovation, we are charged with managing value whilst being reshaped by globalization and technology, which will reshape our future.

As we continue to devote ourselves to serving the global community through education in both management and business programs through DBA, PhD,

EMBA and MBA and other offerings, we must recognize that our study together is really a commitment and conviction that good leadership and management can indeed make countries, companies and societies more capable and more vibrant.

Whilst a growth in enrolment in management education has been noticed in recent years, one curiously observes that motivation for candidacy varies. Some, for example, would treasure the opportunity to have advanced one's standing in a business career, while others are looking to fill space on an office wall or a conversation piece on the golf course. Despite varying motivation, it's fair to acknowledge that the opportunity is really about advancing one's "intellectual ambition" and advancing our organization's inclusion in the global marketplace.

Our role as business educators is to continue our collaboration with our community and society, inspired by innovation and authentic leadership as we go forth to engage the exciting universe of commerce.

如果每隔20年才參加一次領導管理教育，其成效是有限的。研究領導管理時，不應只限於討論最新的潮流和模式，而是必須在堅實的行為科學基礎上，深入剖析領導管理。現時，得以在企業內晉升成高層的管理者，依賴的往往不是創新、激勵及技巧，而是政治頭腦及手段。回到你剛才提出的問題：最近幾年間，這對管理教育構成了極大的影響，針對此議題而發表的理論，總數更超越50,000之多。在競爭愈加激烈及經濟環境持續改變的今天，教育是重中之重。再者，在混亂與運作之間取得平衡，需要的正是領導管理。

過去50多年間，香港及新加坡的父母一直鼓勵子女攻讀醫學、工程、法律及商業等專業學科。其實，任何學科都有其優點和好處，但我的忠告是，如果缺乏人際互動、行為及溝通等方面的學習，畢業生將難以融入這個瞬息萬變的世界，其專業效能亦將大受限制。這在畢業生進行面試時已可見一斑：很多人甚至難以組織出完整有序的句子。事實上，不少人完全缺乏社交技巧，以及對人類行為的基本認知。擁有五年工作經驗的人，在面試及團體活動中仍然顯得不安。這令人對管理教育感到憂心忡忡。

推進管理教育時，應注意哪些事項？

前所未有的激烈競爭及經濟動盪，令盈利能力不斷萎縮，使我們更為關注增長及變化。在這個快速創新的時代，我們負責管理價值的同時，全球化及科技亦重塑我們及未來。

我們致力通過工商管理博士、博士、高級工商管理碩士、工商管理碩士及其它課程推動商業管理教育，以為國際社會服務。與此同時，我們必須認識到，共同努力其實是一個承諾和信念——良好的領導管理能確實賦予國家、企業及社會更大的能力和活力。

儘管近年入讀管理教育課程的學員人數有所增加，但我們注意到，報讀者背後的動機不盡相同。某些人希望藉此在職場上進步，亦有些人希望能夠在辦公室內或高爾夫球場上參與對話。動機雖然不盡相同，但學員均視課程為增進個人知識，並讓企業融入全球市場的機會。

身為商業教育者，我們的職責是繼續與我們所屬的社區及社會合作，憑藉創新及真正的領導管理，參與令人振奮的商業世界。

